

HDip/Cert in Computer Science Progression Pathways



Department of Computing and Mathematics

15/12/2025



setu.ie
INSPIRING FUTURES

What are the options at SETU once I finish the Cert?

1. Direct Entry onto the Higher Diploma in Computer Science
2. Specialism Certificate
3. I'm good thanks – Slán!



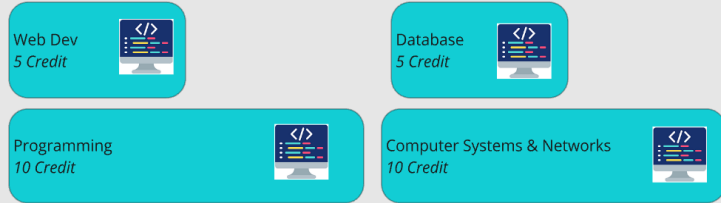
1. Direct Entry onto the Higher Diploma in Computer Science

- Advanced Entry to HDip from Cert
- No Springboard Funding

Sept 25

Jan 26

General

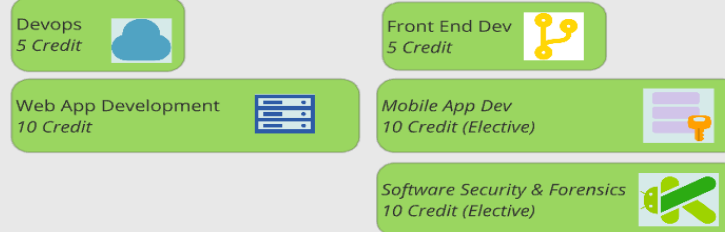


- Springboard Funded
- 1 year Computer Science Fundamentals

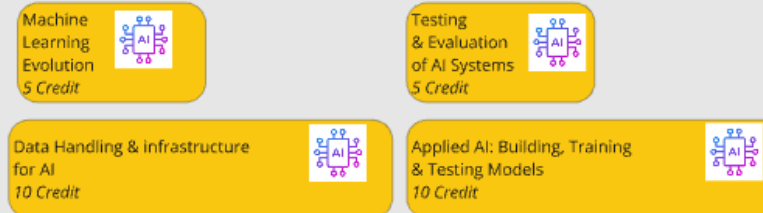
Sept 26

Jan 27

Software Engineering



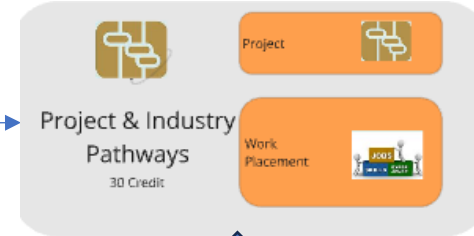
Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning



Cyber Security and Forensics



June 27 – Dec27



— Placement timeframe
June-Sept

2. Cert in Computer Science: Specialism Cert Progression

- Cert Required
- No Springboard Funding
- No Project/Placement



Sept 25

Jan 26

General

Web Dev
5 Credit

Database
5 Credit

Programming
10 Credit

Computer Systems & Networks
10 Credit



- Springboard Funded
- 1 year Computer Science Fundamentals

Sept 26

Jan 27

Software Engineering

Devops
5 Credit

Web App Development
10 Credit

Front End Dev
5 Credit

Mobile App Dev
10 Credit (Elective)

Software Security & Forensics
10 Credit (Elective)

Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning

Machine Learning Evolution
5 Credit

Data Handling & Infrastructure for AI
10 Credit

Testing & Evaluation of AI Systems
5 Credit

Applied AI: Building, Training & Testing Models
10 Credit

Cyber Security and Forensics

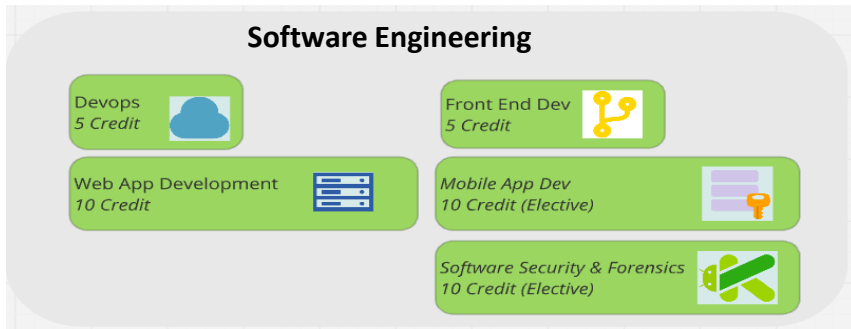
Security & Forensics Fundamentals
5 Credit

Network & Systems Security
10 Credit

Legal & Ethical Aspects of...
5 Credit

Digital Forensics
10 Credit

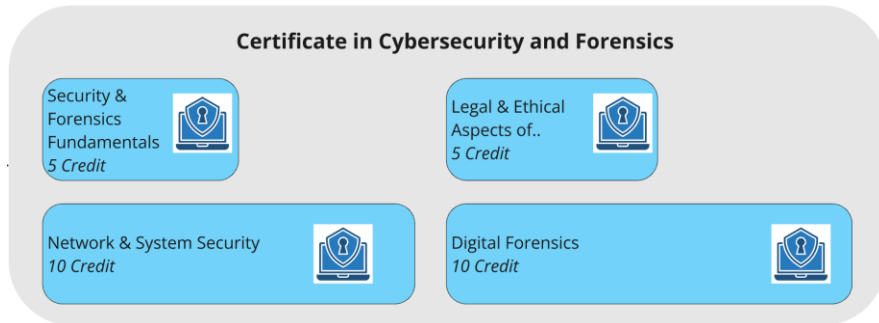
Software Engineering



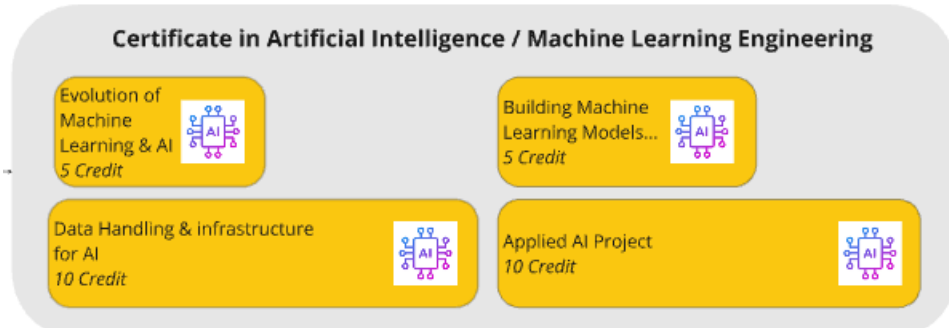
- **Stage 2 of the existing HDip**, retaining core modules but redesigned to integrate AI tools, techniques, and industry practices.
- **Strong industry alignment**, with continuous monitoring of trends and guidance from core industry partners.
- **AI-augmented development**
- Emphasis on developer expertise and judgement
- **Practical curriculum** covering modern full-stack, cloud, microservices, testing, DevOps, and mobile development, reflecting major changes of the last 5 years.
- **Elective Choice:** Mobile App Dev OR Software Security & Forensics in Sem 2

Cybersecurity and Forensics

- **Hands-on, practical focus** on threat detection, secure coding, digital forensics, and regulatory compliance.
- **Industry-driven curriculum** designed to meet current and emerging cybersecurity workforce needs.
- **Supports reskilling and career transition** into high-demand cybersecurity roles.



AI and Machine Learning



- **Hands-on focus** on AI model development, data handling, ML infrastructure, and performance optimisation
- **Industry-aligned curriculum** addressing real-world AI/ML engineering needs across sectors
- **Rigorous, practical learning experience** designed for workplace relevance
- **Supports upskilling and reskilling** into high-demand AI engineering roles